

Harikumar D

Global Engineering & Operations Leader | Product Governance | Risk Oversight | Board Readiness

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Harikumar D. is a seasoned Engineering Governance Leader with 23+ years of global experience spanning aerospace, automotive, and commercial vehicle industries. His career journey began at HAL Aerospace, advancing through Tata Johnson Controls and Mercedes-Benz R&D, before a 15+ year tenure at Volvo Group where he directed engineering governance and program leadership across Volvo Trucks, Mack Trucks, and UD Trucks.

He has consistently driven engineering transformation, embedding Agile governance frameworks, enabling digital engineering adoption, and strengthening supplier ecosystems across North America, Europe, and Asia-Pacific. His leadership has ensured manufacturing readiness, APQP compliance, and lifecycle governance for complex global programs.

Certified through the Independent Director's Databank (IICA), Harikumar brings board-level strategic thinking, enterprise risk awareness, and ESG sensitivity. His international assignments in USA, Germany, and France highlight his ability to lead cross-cultural teams and influence global stakeholders. Recognized for operational excellence, supplier governance, and technology oversight, he is positioned as a board-ready executive capable of contributing to governance, risk management, and strategic innovation.

CORE LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

Engineering Leadership	Program Portfolio Management	Product Lifecycle Management
Corporate Governance	Enterprise Risk Management	Operational Excellence
Supplier Governance	Manufacturing Readiness	APQP VAVE
Agile Transformation	Digital Engineering	Technology Strategy
Board Advisory	Global Engineering Operations	Global Stakeholder Management
Cross-functional Leadership	Strategic Planning	

BUSINESS IMPACT

- Led engineering delivery across multiple global commercial vehicle programs.
 - Improved engineering execution through Agile governance and JIRA implementation.
 - Supported global manufacturing readiness and APQP activities for successful product launches.
 - Strengthened supplier collaboration across North America, Europe, and Asia.
 - Mentored engineers and accelerated team capability through structured coaching.
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CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- 23+ years of engineering and program leadership experience.
- 15+ years with Volvo Group supporting global commercial vehicle programs.

- International assignments in USA, Germany, and France.
- Successfully supported Volvo Trucks, Mack Trucks, and UD Trucks product portfolios.
- Led engineering programs across complete product lifecycle—from concept to production.
- Established Agile Ways of Working and JIRA governance across an engineering department.
- Served as Epic Owner driving engineering planning, visibility, and execution.
- Led cross-functional collaboration involving Engineering, Purchasing, Manufacturing, Build Support, Quality, Suppliers, and Global Product Development.
- Mentored engineers on digital engineering tools, Agile delivery, and engineering processes.
- Experience supporting APQP, manufacturing readiness, supplier governance, and launch excellence.
- Cleared the Independent Director's Databank Proficiency Assessment (IICA).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Volvo Group India Pvt. Ltd.

Specialist Engineer – Interior Living | July 2011 – Present | Bengaluru

Provide engineering leadership for Interior Living systems supporting Volvo Trucks, Mack Trucks, and UD Trucks across global markets. Responsible for product strategy, engineering execution, lifecycle management, supplier governance, manufacturing readiness, and continuous product improvement.

Selected Leadership Achievements

- Lead engineering execution for multiple Interior Living programs across North American and Asian markets.
- Drive Value Analysis & Value Engineering initiatives to optimize product performance, cost, manufacturability, and customer value.
- Partner with Engineering, Purchasing, Manufacturing, Build Support, Aftermarket, Quality, and Suppliers to ensure successful program execution.
- Lead Engineering Change Management and lifecycle maintenance for production programs.
- Improve engineering productivity through Agile Ways of Working and digital engineering practices.
- Established department-wide Agile planning through JIRA dashboards, improving work prioritization, engineering visibility, and execution governance.
- Mentored and coached engineering teams, improving adoption of Agile engineering practices and standardized Ways of Working.
- Provide engineering clarification and technical support to Joint Venture partners to ensure seamless product implementation.
- Support supplier development, design reviews, validation activities, production readiness, and launch governance.

International Assignment

Volvo Group North America | Greensboro, North Carolina, USA | April 2014 – July 2014

Selected to support global industrialization and launch readiness activities for North American truck programs.

Key contributions included:

- Strengthened collaboration between Global Product Development and manufacturing plants.
 - Improved supplier engagement and engineering communication.
 - Facilitated production setup alignment across Engineering, Manufacturing, and Supplier organizations.
 - Coordinated APQP deliverables and launch readiness reviews.
 - Helped ensure successful manufacturing readiness through structured cross-functional governance.
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Mercedes-Benz Research & Development India (MBRDI), Pune

Lead Engineer | April 2010 – July 2011

Led engineering design and packaging of automotive seating systems for premium vehicle platforms while ensuring compliance with European safety regulations.

Highlights:

- Packaging and engineering of seating systems.
 - CAD modelling and engineering calculations.
 - Safety compliance.
 - Design validation.
 - Global engineering collaboration.
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Tata Johnson Controls Automotive Ltd. (Now Adient), Pune

Senior Design Engineer | September 2004 – April 2010

Designed seating systems for global automotive OEMs including General Motors, Volvo, Renault, DaimlerChrysler and Nissan.

International Assignment

Johnson Controls GmbH (Germany) | Advanced Engineering | March 2006 – February 2008

Worked in the Global Innovation organization developing next-generation seating technologies.

Responsibilities included:

- Advanced engineering concepts
- Mechanism development
- Feasibility studies
- Concept validation
- Innovation programs

Johnson Controls France | Les Ulis | July 2008

Supported Renault Business Unit in resolving latch release cable issues through engineering investigation and root cause analysis.

Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL), Bengaluru**CAD/CAM Engineer | February 2003 – August 2004**

Supported aerospace manufacturing through CATIA V4 CAD modeling and CAM programming.

GLOBAL EXPERIENCE

India | Germany | France | United States

Worked with stakeholders across:

North America | Europe | Japan | Thailand | Asia-Pacific

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Introduced Agile Ways of Working across the CAB engineering organization.
 - Established JIRA dashboards improving engineering planning and execution visibility.
 - Successfully completed international assignments supporting engineering innovation, manufacturing readiness, and launch excellence.
 - Led mentoring and capability development for engineers and new team members.
 - Team Captain for an 85-member organization, leading the team to multiple championship victories.
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GOVERNANCE & BOARD READINESS

- Independent Director Databank Proficiency Assessment – IICA
 - Governance knowledge: risk oversight, technology governance, supplier governance
 - Strategic decision support for board-level discussions
 - Strong understanding of engineering governance and operational risk.
 - Experience in supplier governance and manufacturing oversight.
 - Cross-cultural leadership across global organizations.
 - Interest in Corporate Governance, ESG, Technology Strategy, and Enterprise Risk Management
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EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- B.E. Mechanical Engineering – MVJ College of Engineering
- Diploma in Mechanical Engineering – School of Mines, KGF
- Independent Director's Databank Certification – IICA
- German Integration Course & Language Level 1